

BEE 4750 Homework 1: Introduction to Using Julia

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Due Date

Thursday, 9/11/25, 9:00pm

Overview

Instructions

- Problem 1 consist of a series of code snippets for you to interpret and debug. You will be asked to identify relevant error(s) and fix the code.
- Problem 2 asks you to write code to implement several simple functions using more general programming and some which are unique to Julia (which might mean that you need to look at the documentation or use Julia's help function, which is accessed with `?`, e.g. `?sum` for help with the `sum()` function) or to analyze Julia syntax.
- Problem 3 asks you to convert a verbal description of a wastewater treatment system into a Julia function, and then to use that function to explore the impact of different wastewater allocation strategies.

Load Environment

The following code loads the environment and makes sure all needed packages are installed. This should be at the start of most Julia scripts.

```
import Pkg
Pkg.activate(@__DIR__)
Pkg.instantiate()
```

Activating project at `~/bee4750-hw1-ero23`

Standard Julia practice is to load all needed packages at the top of a file. If you need to load any additional packages in any assignments beyond those which are loaded by default, feel free to add a `using` statement, though [you may need to install the package](#).

```
using Random
using Plots
using GraphRecipes
using LaTeXStrings
using Distributions
```

```
# this sets a random seed, which ensures reproducibility of random number generation. You sh
Random.seed!(1)
```

TaskLocalRNG()

Problems (Total: 30 Points)

Problem 1 (12 points)

The following subproblems all involve code snippets that require debugging. You are encouraged to use online resources (*e.g.* Julia documentation and forums, Stack Overflow, Reddit, etc) to help find diagnose error messages and find solutions, but make sure that you clearly document which resources you used and how you used them.

Problem 1.1

You've been tasked with writing code to identify the minimum value in an array. You cannot use a predefined function. Your colleague suggested the function below, but it does not return the minimum value.

```
function minimum(array)
    # initialize the minimum value counter
    min_value = array[1]
    # update minimum values
    for i in 1:length(array)
        if array[i] < min_value
            min_value = array[i]
        end
    end
end
```

```

    end
    # return found minimum
    return min_value
end

array_values = [89, 90, 95, 100, 100, 78, 99, 98, 100, 95]
@show minimum(array_values);

```

```
minimum(array_values) = 78
```

The minimum value was set to zero to start, when it should be set to the first value in the array. By changing the 0 to `array[1]` (not `array[0]` because Julia doesn't start at 0) it is now looping through the array and returning the value that is the lowest in the array, instead of only returning something in the array if there is a value less than 0.

What is the logical flaw in the code? Fix it and show that your fixed code solves the problem.

Problem 1.2

Your team is trying to compute the average grade for your class, but the following code produces an `UndefVarError`.

```

# enter student grade vector
student_grades = [89, 90, 95, 100, 100, 78, 99, 98, 100, 95]
# compute class average
function class_average(grades)
    average_grade = mean(student_grades)
    return average_grade
end

@show class_average(student_grades);

```

```
class_average(student_grades) = 94.4
```

The error means it is calling a variable that does not exist to be called (it is only defined within the function). The last line is trying to call a value that is inside a function. It needed to be changed to call the function on that array, rather than the variable inside of the function itself.

What does this `UndefVarError` mean? Why does this code produce one? Fix the error and solve the problem.

Problem 1.3

Your team wants to know the expected payout of an old Italian dice game called *passadieci* (which was analyzed by Galileo as one of the first examples of a rigorous study of probability). The goal of *passadieci* is to get at least an 11 from rolling three fair, six-sided dice. Your strategy is to compute the average wins from 1,000 trials, but the code you've written below produces a `MethodError`.

```
# function to simulate a passedieci roll: 3 6-sided dice
function passedieci()
    # this rand() call samples 3 values from the vector [1, 6]
    roll = rand(1:6, 3)
    return roll
end

# set number of trials and initialize outcome vector
n_trials = 1_000
outcomes = []
# simulate number of passedieci rolls and count wins
for i = 1:n_trials
    push!(outcomes, (sum(passadieci()) > 11))
end

win_prob = sum(outcomes) / n_trials # compute average number of wins
@show win_prob;
```

```
win_prob = 0.379
```

(NOTE: `_` is just used for readability, 1,000 is written as `1_000`). I believe the error was due to trying to add an `Int64` into an array as if the value were an array itself. To fix this I just created an empty array and added each value to that array instead of replacing the values that were originally zeros.

What does this `MethodError` mean? Why does this code produce one? Fix the error and solve the problem.

Problem 1.4

You're interested in writing some code to remove the mean of a vector from all of its components. You've written the following code and tried to test it on a random vector, but your code returns a `MethodError`.

```

# function to remove mean from a vector
function remove_mean(vect)
    # fucntion to compute the mean
    function compute_mean(vect)
        element_sum = 0 # initialize sum
        # compute mean and return
        for v in vect
            element_sum += v
        end
        return element_sum / length(vect)
    end

    m = compute_mean(vect) # compute mean
    # return demeaned vector
    return vect .- m
end

random_vect = rand(1_000)
@show remove_mean(random_vect)

```

```
remove_mean(random_vect) = [-0.1023457359876736, -0.3229908927920322, -0.10921503933487609, ...]
```

```
1000-element Vector{Float64}:
```

```

-0.1023457359876736
-0.3229908927920322
-0.10921503933487609
 0.34907808322405554
 0.08289804346358298
 0.21116585975368274
 0.24101483316150385
-0.2735800738434452
-0.24932284313541186
 0.4097559976606454

-0.1741305753231739
-0.07629261528630848
-0.029215855728358275
-0.018599821930943228
-0.23770589614199222
-0.16315312688441108
 0.21258612076713523

```

```
-0.4049548925664671
0.008692232042929238
```

The Method Error is due to trying to subtract a scalar value from a vector with only -
It needs to use the `.-` syntax so that it is subtracting the mean from every value within the vector.

What does this `MethodError` mean? Why does this code produce one? Fix the error and solve the problem.

Problem 2 (18 points)

Cheap Plastic Products, Inc. is operating a plant that produces $100\text{m}^3/\text{day}$ of wastewater that is discharged into Pristine Brook. The wastewater contains $1\text{kg}/\text{m}^3$ of YUK, a toxic substance. The US Environmental Protection Agency has imposed an effluent standard on the plant prohibiting discharge of more than $20\text{kg}/\text{day}$ of YUK into Pristine Brook.

Cheap Plastic Products has analyzed two methods for reducing its discharges of YUK. Method 1 is land disposal, which costs $X_1^2/20$ dollars per day, where X_1 is the amount of wastewater disposed of on the land (m^3/day). With this method, 20% of the YUK applied to the land will eventually drain into the stream (*i.e.*, 80% of the YUK is removed by the soil).

Method 2 is a chemical treatment procedure which costs $\$1.50$ per m^3 of wastewater treated. The chemical treatment has an efficiency of $e = 1 - 0.005X_2$, where X_2 is the quantity of wastewater (m^3/day) treated. For example, if $X_2 = 50\text{m}^3/\text{day}$, then $e = 1 - 0.005(50) = 0.75$, so that 75% of the YUK is removed.

Cheap Plastic Products is wondering how to allocate their wastewater between these three disposal and treatment methods (land disposal, chemical treatment, and direct disposal) to meet the effluent standard while keeping costs manageable.

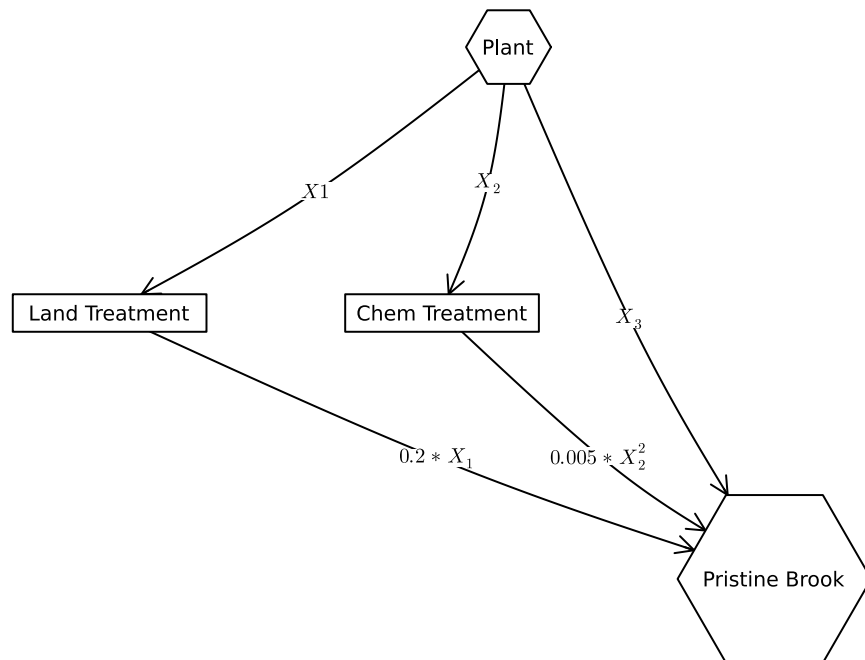
The flow of wastewater through this treatment system is shown in Figure 1. Modify the edge labels (by editing the `edge_labels` dictionary in the code producing Figure 1) to show how the wastewater allocations result in the final YUK discharge into Pristine Brook. For the `edge_label` dictionary, the tuple (i, j) corresponds to the arrow going from node i to node j . The syntax for any entry is $(i, j) \Rightarrow \text{"label text"}$, and the label text can include mathematical notation if the string is prefaced with an L, as in `L"x_1"` will produce x_1 .

```
A = [0 1 1 1;
      0 0 0 1;
      0 0 0 1;
      0 0 0 0]

names = ["Plant", "Land Treatment", "Chem Treatment", "Pristine Brook"]
```

```
# modify this dictionary to add labels
edge_labels = Dict((1, 2) => L"X1", (1,3) => L"X2", (1, 4) => L"X3", (2, 4) => L"0.2*X1", (3, 4) => L"0.005*X2^2")
shapes=[:hexagon, :rect, :rect, :hexagon]
xpos = [0, -1.5, -0.25, 1]
ypos = [1, 0, 0, -1]

p = graphplot(A, names=names, edgelabel=edge_labels, markersize=0.15, markershapes=shapes, margin=10)
display(p)
```



Problem 2.1

Formulate a mathematical model for the treatment cost and the amount of YUK that will be discharged into Pristine Brook based on the wastewater allocations. This is best done with some equations and supporting text explaining the derivation. Make sure you include, as additional equations in the model, any needed constraints on relevant values. You can find some basics on writing mathematical equations using the LaTeX typesetting syntax [here](#), and a cheatsheet with LaTeX commands can be found on the course website's [Resources](#) page.

Given three different flows $((X_1, X_2, X_3))$, we can calculate the total YUK that will flow into Pristine Brook and the associated cost.

The **cost function** (dependent on the land and chemical treatments) is:

$$\text{Cost}(X_1, X_2) = \frac{X_1^2}{20} + 1.50 X_2$$

The **discharge function** (total YUK entering Pristine Brook) is:

$$\text{Discharge}(X_1, X_2, X_3) = 0.2X_1 + 0.005X_2^2 + X_3$$

To meet EPA standards, the total discharge must satisfy:

$$\text{Discharge}(X_1, X_2, X_3) \leq 20$$

Problem 2.2

Implement your systems model as a Julia function which computes the resulting YUK discharge and cost for a particular treatment plan. You can return multiple values from a function with a [tuple](#), as in:

```
function multiple_return_values(x, y)
    return (x+y, x*y)
end

a, b = multiple_return_values(2, 5)
@show a;
@show b;
```

```
a = 7
b = 10
```

To evaluate the function over vectors of inputs, you can *broadcast* the function by adding a decimal `.` before the function arguments and accessing the resulting values by writing a *comprehension* to loop over the individual outputs in the vector:


```
x = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]
y = [6, 7, 8, 9, 10]
```

```
output = multiple_return_values.(x, y)
a = [out[1] for out in output]
b = [out[2] for out in output]
@show a;
@show b;
```

```
a = [7, 9, 11, 13, 15]
b = [6, 14, 24, 36, 50]
```

```
# Parameters
Q = 100 #m^3 / day or kg YUK/day
S = 20 #kg YUK / day (Envi Standard)

#Functions
function YUK_outflow(X1, X2, X3)
    land_output = X1 * 0.2
    chem_output = 0.005 * X2^2
    direct_output = X3
    total_YUK = land_output + chem_output + direct_output
    return (total_YUK)
end

function cost(X1, X2)
    return (X1^2 / 20 + 1.50 * X2)
end

#if land_output + chem_output + X3 <= 20

n = 1000
rand_ratios = rand(Dirichlet(3, 1.0), n)

discharges = zeros(n)
costs = zeros(n)
X = Q .* rand_ratios #turning all the flow ratios into the actual flows
X1 = X[1,:]
X2 = X[2,:]
X3 = X[3,:]
```

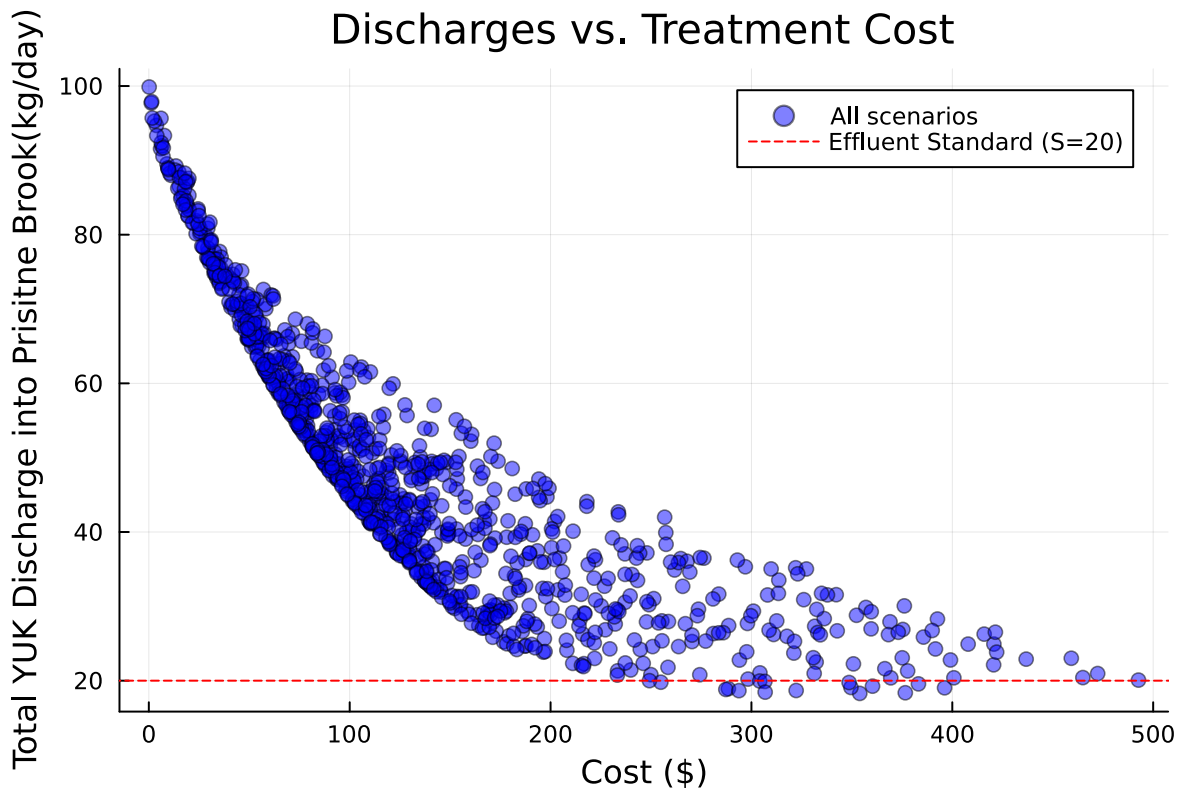
```

discharges = YUK_outflow.(X1, X2, X3) #Using Broadcasting instead of for loop!!
costs = cost.(X1, X2)

#Plotting
scatter(costs, discharges, color=:blue, alpha=0.5, label="All scenarios",
        xlabel="Cost (\$)", ylabel="Total YUK Discharge into Prisitne Brook(kg/day)",
        title="Discharges vs. Treatment Cost")

hline!([S], color=:red, linestyle=:dash, label="Effluent Standard (S=20)") #Effluent Standard

```



Make sure you comment your code appropriately to make it clear what is going on and why.

Problem 2.3

Use your function to experiment with 1,000 different combinations of wastewater discharge and treatment. You can do this with either a grid search or by sampling from a [Dirichlet distribution](#) (a $\text{Dirichlet}(1, n)$ distribution will generate uniformly-weighted n -dimensional vectors whose components add up to 1; see the [Distributions.jl documentation](#) for how to sample from probability distributions in Julia). Plot the results of these experiments. Do any

satisfy the YUK effluent standard (plot this as well as a dashed red line). What was the cost of solutions satisfying the standard? What can you say about the tradeoff between treatment cost and YUK discharge? You don't have to find an "optimal" solution to this problem, but what do you think would be needed to find a better solution?

A few of the results meet the effluent standard, the minimum cost seems to be around \$250. The obvious increase in cost to decrease the YUK concentration going into the Brook. To find the optimal solution it would probably be better to use some function that will narrow down a range (like around 250) rather than just sampling random ratios for the flows and seeing what is best.

Problem 2.4

Find the strategies which minimize cost and YUK discharge (these will be different strategies) analytically and find the values of the objective metrics. Plot these values in the plot that you created for Problem 2.3. How do their values compare to the spread of values that you found in that problem? Would you select either of them (explain why or why not)?

To find the minimum cost I assumed the entire flow would go directly into the Pristine Brook, as this option has no cost. This would result in 100kg YUK / day, but a cost of \$0. To find the minimum YUK level it was not as simple. To do this I assumed no flow would go directly into the brook (as this has no treatment) setting $X_3 = 0$, I then also set $X_1 = 100 - X_2$, so that I could rewrite the formula with a singular variable. I then took the derivative and found that $X_2 = 20$ meaning $X_1 = 80$. Using these values gets a YUK value of 18kg/day and a cost of \$350.

```
# Min-cost strategy
X1_minC = 0
X2_minC = 0
X3_minC = 100
YUK_minC = YUK_outflow(X1_minC, X2_minC, X3_minC)
Cost_minC = cost(X1_minC, X2_minC)

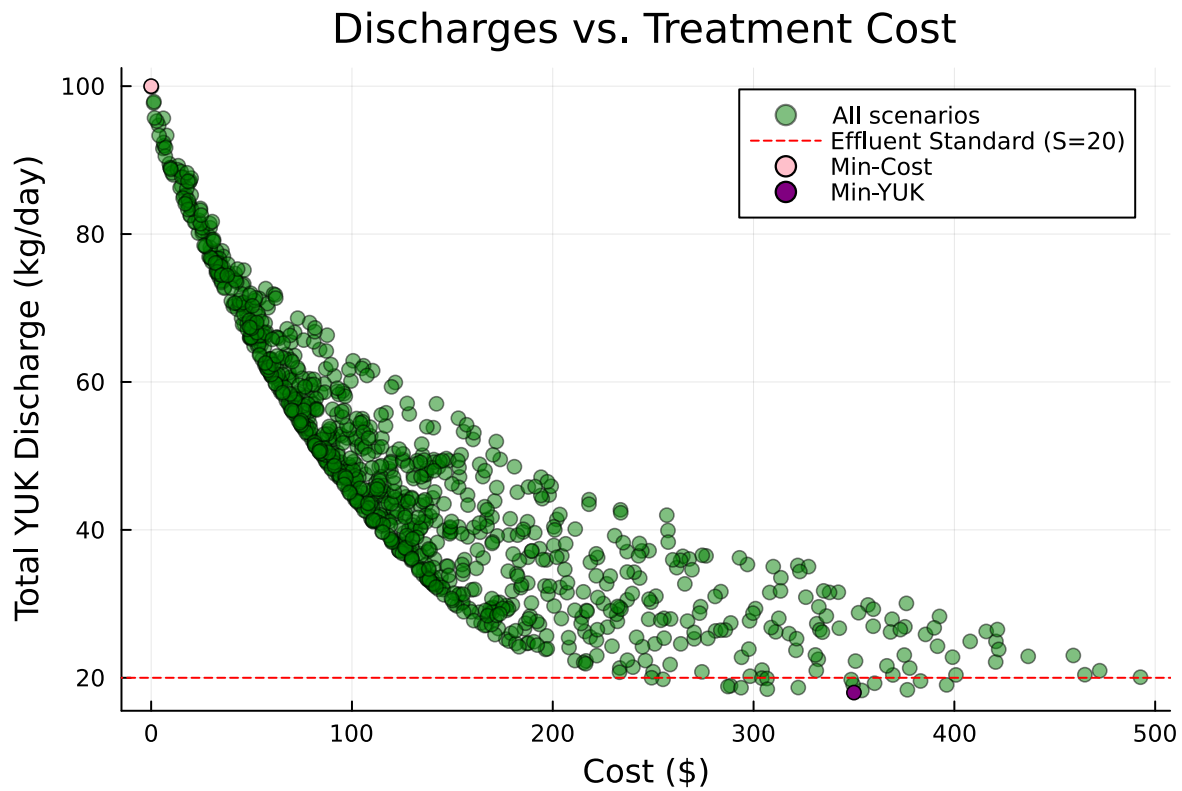
# Min-YUK strategy
X1_minYUK = 80
X2_minYUK = 20
X3_minYUK = 0
YUK_minYUK = YUK_outflow(X1_minYUK, X2_minYUK, X3_minYUK)
Cost_minYUK = cost(X1_minYUK, X2_minYUK)

# Plot
scatter(costs, discharges, color=:green, alpha=0.5, label="All scenarios",
        xlabel="Cost (\$)", ylabel="Total YUK Discharge (kg/day)",
```

```

title="Discharges vs. Treatment Cost")
hline!([S], color=:red, linestyle=:dash, label="Effluent Standard (S=20)")
scatter!([Cost_minC], [YUK_minC], color=:pink, label="Min-Cost")
scatter!([Cost_minYUK], [YUK_minYUK], color=:purple, label="Min-YUK")

```



References

<https://docs.juliaplots.org/stable/>
<https://docs.julialang.org/en/v1/manual/arrays/>